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# PROPOSAL FOR MANAGED CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURE & CYBERSECURITY SERVICES

Submitted by NexaCloud Solutions Ltd in Response to  
RFP-GOV-2024-0147

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|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reference Number:        | NCS-PROP-2024-0147                                            |
| Issuing Organisation:    | NexaCloud Solutions Ltd, 12 Meridian Tower, Techport, Aravand |
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# 1. Executive Summary

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NexaCloud Solutions Ltd is pleased to submit this proposal in response to RFP-GOV-2024-0147. With over 14 years of experience delivering mission-critical cloud infrastructure to public sector organisations across 22 countries, NexaCloud is uniquely positioned to deliver the Government of Aravand's digital transformation ambitions safely, securely, and on schedule.

We propose a fully managed, sovereign cloud platform built on our AravandGov Cloud architecture — a purpose-built, multi-region environment hosted exclusively within Aravand's national territory. Our solution is designed from the ground up to exceed every Mandatory requirement in this RFP while delivering exceptional value for money and a 10-year sustainability roadmap.

## 2. Technical Compliance

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### 2.1 Infrastructure & Availability

NexaCloud will deploy the AravandGov platform across three geographically distinct Tier IV data centres: AV-NORTH (Kalstad), AV-CENTRAL (Port Aravand), and AV-SOUTH (Minerva Bay). This tri-region architecture exceeds the minimum dual-region requirement and provides N+2 redundancy at every tier.

Our platform guarantees a minimum system uptime of 99.95% measured on a rolling monthly basis, backed by a contractual Service Level Agreement. This exceeds the 99.9% minimum requirement. Our historical performance across all government clients in 2023 was 99.97% aggregate uptime. Planned maintenance windows are capped at two hours per calendar month and are exclusively scheduled between 02:00 and 04:00 local time on Sundays.

API response times are guaranteed not to exceed 150 milliseconds at the 95th percentile under normal operating load, and not to exceed 200 milliseconds at the 99th percentile. Our real-time performance dashboard will be made available to the Department's technical team via a dedicated portal from day one of the contract.

The AravandGov platform is designed and tested to support a minimum of 250,000 concurrent user sessions. Full load testing results, including third-party validation reports, are included in Appendix C of this proposal.

### 2.2 Security & Encryption

All data at rest and in transit is encrypted using AES-256-GCM encryption, which meets and exceeds the FIPS 140-2 Level 3 validation requirement. NexaCloud employs a dedicated Hardware Security Module (HSM) cluster — specifically the Thales Luna Network HSM 7 — for all cryptographic key management operations, ensuring no key material ever exists in software memory.

Multi-Factor Authentication is enforced by default for all privileged accounts from day one. All government end-user accounts will have MFA enforced within 30 days of go-live, ahead of the six-month requirement. We support FIDO2/WebAuthn hardware tokens, TOTP authenticator apps, and SMS-based OTP as fallback only for non-sensitive tiers.

Our 24/7 Security Operations Centre (SOC) conducts automated vulnerability scanning every 24 hours using a combination of Qualys VMDR and Tenable.io. Critical vulnerabilities (CVSS score  $\geq 9.0$ ) are remediated within 48 hours of detection — beating the 72-hour requirement. High severity vulnerabilities are resolved within 10 calendar days.

Annual independent security audits are conducted by CREST-certified auditors. The most recent audit report (January 2024) is included as Appendix D. Our Zero-Trust Architecture ensures that no implicit trust is granted to any network entity, user, or workload.

## **2.3 Support & Service Levels**

NexaCloud operates a dedicated 24-hours-a-day, 7-days-a-week technical support service. Our guaranteed response times are: Priority 1 (Critical) — 15 minutes; Priority 2 (High) — 1 hour; Priority 3 (Medium) — 4 hours; Priority 4 (Low) — 1 business day. All targets exceed the contractual minimums stated in the RFP.

A named Senior Technical Account Manager (TAM) will be assigned exclusively to the Government of Aravand account. The TAM will hold a formal monthly service review, produce written minutes within 3 business days, and be available via dedicated direct line during business hours.

## **2.4 Backup & Disaster Recovery**

Automated backups run every 4 hours for all Tier-1 workloads and daily for all other workloads. Full system backups are retained for 180 days. Point-in-time recovery is available at 5-minute granularity for all relational database services.

Our documented and annually tested Disaster Recovery Plan guarantees a Recovery Time Objective (RTO) of 2 hours and a Recovery Point Objective (RPO) of 15 minutes for all Tier-1 critical workloads — both significantly below the RFP thresholds of 4 hours and 1 hour respectively. DR testing is conducted twice per year with full results shared with the Department.

### 3. Legal Compliance & Certifications

NexaCloud Solutions Ltd holds the following current certifications, all valid at the time of submission (copies enclosed as Appendix A):

| Certification                      | Reference                                                                     | Status                     |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| ISO/IEC 27001:2022                 | Certificate No. ISB-2022-NCS-04471                                            | Valid until: March 2026    |
| SOC 2 Type II Attestation          | Covering Security, Availability & Confidentiality Report dated: November 2023 |                            |
| ISO 9001:2015 (Quality Management) | Certificate No. QM-2023-NCS-00812                                             | Valid until: July 2025     |
| Cyber Essentials Plus (NCSC)       | Certificate No. CE+-2023-8847                                                 | Valid until: December 2024 |

All staff assigned to this contract will hold a minimum of BPSS clearance prior to commencement. Personnel requiring access to OFFICIAL-SENSITIVE systems have been submitted for Security Check (SC) clearance. Our dedicated Data Protection Officer is Ms. Sarah Okonkwo (dpo@nexacloud.com), appointed in accordance with GDPR Article 37. All data processing complies fully with the Aravand Data Protection Act 2021.

#### 3.1 Insurance Coverage

NexaCloud maintains the following insurance coverage, all naming 'The Government of Aravand' as an additional insured party. Certificates of insurance are enclosed as Appendix B:

| Insurance Type             | Coverage                      | Status                  |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Professional Indemnity     | GBP 15,000,000 per occurrence | Exceeds RFP requirement |
| Cyber Liability Insurance  | GBP 10,000,000 per occurrence | Exceeds RFP requirement |
| Public Liability Insurance | GBP 10,000,000 per occurrence | Exceeds RFP requirement |
| Employer's Liability       | GBP 10,000,000 (statutory)    | Meets RFP requirement   |

## 4. Financial & Commercial Terms

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Our pricing is fixed for the initial 36-month term. All pricing is stated in Aravand Pounds Sterling and is fully inclusive — there are no hidden fees, no charges outside the Schedule of Rates, and no volume-based surcharges within the agreed service envelope. A detailed Schedule of Rates is provided in Appendix E.

We accept the Department's payment terms of 30 days from receipt of a valid invoice. Monthly invoices will be submitted by the 5th of each month in arrears, accompanied by a full service consumption report. We accept electronic funds transfer as the payment method.

NexaCloud Solutions Ltd has an annual turnover of APS 340 million. Audited financial statements for 2021, 2022, and 2023 are enclosed as Appendix F. We will provide the required Performance Bond of 10% of annual contract value within 15 days of contract award.

## 5. Operational Commitments

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### 5.1 Training & Documentation

NexaCloud will deliver a structured training programme for up to 600 government IT administrators and end-users within 45 days of go-live — ahead of the 60-day requirement and exceeding the maximum headcount. Training will be available in instructor-led classroom, live virtual, and self-paced online formats via our GovLearn portal.

All technical documentation — architecture diagrams, runbooks, API guides, and security baselines — will be hosted on a dedicated knowledge portal. Documentation will be updated within 5 working days of any platform change, well ahead of the 15-day requirement.

### 5.2 Reporting

A comprehensive Monthly Service Report will be delivered by the 5th working day of each following month, five days ahead of the contractual deadline. Reports will include uptime statistics, P1-P4 incident volumes and MTTR, security event summaries, vulnerability remediation status, capacity utilisation, and a forward-looking risk register.

### 5.3 Sustainability

NexaCloud is committed to net-zero carbon emissions for all data centre operations by 2028 — two years ahead of the 2030 target. All three AravandGov data centres are powered by 100% verified renewable energy. We will submit a comprehensive annual Environmental Impact Report covering energy, carbon, and water metrics.

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NexaCloud Solutions Ltd confirms that this proposal is valid for 120 days from the submission deadline and that all information provided is accurate and complete. We welcome the opportunity to present our solution to the evaluation panel.